

Hazim Zaidi

MScR, BSc

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PROFILE

Hazim is a proactive project manager with a strong track record in managing grant-funded projects across a portfolio valued at approximately £5.2M and growing. His expertise spans the full project lifecycle, from bid writing and stakeholder coordination through to delivery and reporting - having successfully closed multiple funded projects while developing deep specialisms in geospatial data, retrofit, and net zero. Beyond the UK, Hazim has been instrumental in expanding City Science's international footprint, leading business development efforts in the US and Malaysia and managing the company's first international collaboration with Korean technology partners.

CORE SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

Programme & Project Management

Innovate UK Grant Management · Project Planning & Delivery · Stakeholder Coordination · Budget & Timeline Management · Quarterly Reporting

Technical & Data

Geospatial Data (GIS/QGIS) · Data Modelling · Digital Twins · Transport Modelling · Environmental Research

Bid Writing & Comms

Bid Writing & Fundraising · Award Nominations · Net Zero & Retrofit

Tools & Platforms

VS Code & GitLab · Jira · Miro (UI/UX Design) · WordPress CMS · HubSpot CRM

ACADEMIC TRAINING

2021 – 2023 University of Bristol

MScR Global Environmental Challenges — Cabot Institute for the Environment

2019 – 2021 University of Bristol

BSc Environmental Geoscience

PROFESSIONAL HISTORY

Feb 2025 – Present City Science

Research & Development Programme Manager

Jan 2024 – Jan 2025 City Science

Graduate Research & Development Programme Manager

June 2019 – Present Solarable

Project Lead

PROJECT EXPERIENCE — PROGRAMME MANAGER

Exploiting Quantum Computing for Large-Scale Transport Models | 2024 | Innovate UK #10030783

Coordinated collaboration between City Science and the University of Exeter to enhance quantum computing capabilities. Ensured timely execution within budget and delivered comprehensive reports to Innovate UK.

Public Consultation Tool for Net Zero Planning | 2024 | Innovate UK #10088369

Managed development of a consultation tool with marketing partner Growth Guides. Delivered innovative features enabling local authorities to gather public perception at key decision-making stages of Net Zero planning.

Integrated Mixed Traffic Mobility for HERT (Mass Transit 2) | 2024 | Innovate UK #10088787

Led feasibility study into automated vehicles with Hertfordshire City Council. Project closed on time and on budget, receiving high praise from Innovate UK for project management effectiveness.

AI for Multi-Modal Model Generation in Transport | 2024–2025 | Innovate UK #10105017

Managed collaboration between City Science, University of Exeter, and England's Economic Heartland. Focused on developing a multi-mode transport model for the EEH region.

Revolutionising Rural Connectivity | 2024–2025 | Innovate UK #10109661

Managed development of a Transport Needs Assessment using Cadence capabilities for Somerset Council. The project won the CIHT SouthWest Innovation Award and was Commended for Transport Project of the Year 2025.

AI for Mass Model Automation: Phase 2 | 2024–2025 | Innovate UK #10123830

Oversaw collaboration with the University of Exeter to build modelling features for the wider EEH transportation model, implementing AI to reduce resource-intensive work done by traditional transport modellers.

Digital Twins for Advanced Collaborative Energy System Planning | 2024–2025 | Innovate UK #10128178

Managed a three-way collaboration between City Science, National Grid Energy Distribution (NGED), and Space Clippers. Supported technical specification writing and gap analysis of substation data across the UK.

Beyond Smart Junctions | 2025 | Innovate UK #10078658

City Science's first international collaboration, partnering with Korea's Nota AI and the University of Exeter to enhance traffic modelling for UK local authorities. Brought in as PM to ensure successful completion by August 2025.

DESNZ: Home Energy Model (Lot 2 & 3) | 2025–2027

Part of the project management team commissioned by the Department of Energy Security and Net Zero to lead Lots 2 & 3 of the Home Energy Model — replacing the Standard Assessment Procedure in Building Regulations. Expected completion April 2027.

PortLAEP: Digital Twin for Maritime Decarbonisation | 2025 | Innovate UK #10160838

Managing collaboration between City Science, University of Exeter, and Hull City Council to develop a digital twin tool improving shipping and port carbon assessment and energy modelling.

Storytelling Without Borders | 2025 | Innovate UK #10162663

Project managing City Science's expansion of Cadence GIS software into the US market. Leads communication with the Department of Business and Trade to maximise commercial impact.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE — TECHNICAL CONTRIBUTIONS

Cadence US Data Ingestion — Storytelling Without Borders | 2025–2026

As the programme manager and data analyst on Storytelling Without Borders, I took ownership of Cadence's first-ever US dataset integration: I identified and extracted relevant demographic data from the US Census Bureau, converted raw files into Cadence-compatible formats, and successfully uploaded them to the platform, enabling the software's debut deployment in the American market.

Cadence LGA QGIS Training | 2026

I was involved in the delivery of QGIS software training for local authority staff across the UK, equipping councils with the geospatial skills needed to work independently with Cadence, contributing to City Science's project of embedding GIS capability in the public sector throughout 2026.

Investment Grade Proposals for Portfolio Retrofit | 2024 | £1.5M Innovate UK

As the lead sensor strategy for a £1.5M Innovate UK project, I selected and implemented Purmmatrix hardware across 5+ properties to enable real-time energy monitoring. I managed the end-to-end retrofit process, including insulation upgrades and stakeholder coordination, delivering the project on time and to specification.

Consumer-Focused Net Zero Buildings Recommendations Tool | Feb–Jul 2024

I was tasked with improving the UX of a consumer-facing net zero tool, designed web and mobile app interfaces in Miro to translate complex retrofit recommendations into accessible user journeys. The bespoke designs were later adopted as the foundation for City Science's One-Stop-Shop Retrofit Tool.

Winchester Parking Scenario Modelling | Jan–Apr 2024

I was brought in to support quantitative analysis for Winchester City Council's parking strategy, modelled multiple parking allocation scenarios using VS Code and proprietary software. Findings were incorporated into a City Science report that directly informed the Council's 2025 parking decisions.

City Science WordPress Website Management | Jan 2024 – Present

I took ownership of City Science's WordPress website as primary manager, responsible for publishing case studies, project blogs, and company announcements. Ensured consistent and timely dissemination of City Science's work to external audiences, supporting the organisation's visibility and communications strategy.

BID WRITING INVOLVEMENTS

- **Retrofit Initiatives:** Contributed to bid development for retrofit projects, including estimating fabric energy efficiency using EPC metrics. Key involvement in The Big Retrofit Challenge.
- **Tees Valley LAEPs:** Supported the winning bid for Local Area Energy Plans, aligning with regional decarbonisation strategies.
- **CarbonTrack:** Feasibility Study for Manufacturing Emissions and Optimisation Platform. Involved in writing the bid from start, identifying project partners which led to City Science winning £100,000 funding.
- **UK–Malaysia Innovation Collaboration:** Actively lead the collaboration discussions between local authorities and energy companies in Malaysia for potential collaboration focused on sustainable energy solutions and innovation exchange.

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

- **Cambridge Policy Hackathon 2026 Mentor,** Cambridge Judge Business School. Invited as expert for innovation and grant strategy, providing industry guidance to participants on best pitching and funding application practices.
- **Exeter Property Awards 2024:** Led the nomination that resulted in City Science winning the Sustainability Award.
- **CIHT SouthWest Awards 2025:** Led the award-winning nomination for the Revolutionising Rural Connectivity project — Innovation Award Winner & Commended Transport Project of the Year.
- **CITTI Awards 2025:** Led the nomination resulting in City Science winning the Transport Planning Award.